

Shah Burj Quadrangle

شاہ برج کا صحن

1. Basic Facts

- Built by: Emperor Shah Jahan's building programme
- Built in: Shah Jahan's reign (17th century)
- Cost: Not documented in available sources
- Built for: The residence of the empress; today regarded as the best-preserved section of the fort

2. Construction Details

- Contents: The Naulakha Pavilion (west), the Musamman Burj and Sheesh Mahal (north), and an extensive basement beneath the quadrangle serving as a cool summer residence for the empress
- Materials/technique: Not separately itemised beyond its constituent buildings

3. Historical Background

- Because it housed the empress's private residence, this quadrangle was designed for restricted access, which is part of why it has survived in better condition than more publicly-trafficked parts of the fort.

4. Interesting Facts / Trivia

- Its status today as the fort's "best-preserved section" is a direct legacy of it having always been the most private and protected part of the complex - restricted access historically may be part of why it required less repair later.

5. Scenario / Narrative Moment

Set apart from the noise of public audiences and processions, this quiet quarter of the fort was built for one person's daily life rather than an empire's spectacle - which may be exactly why so much more of it has survived intact than the grander, more public halls nearby.